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Course: DH-101-01

Networks of knowledge and power

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1. [Network visualization](#)
2. Network analysis:

This network maps my personal AI ecosystem, connecting the platforms I use, the features they provide, and the companies that develop them. At first glance, I appear to be the central node, as multiple applications—ChatGPT, Gemini, TikTok, Spotify, and Meta AI—are directly connected to me through “use” relationships. However, a closer analysis reveals that power is actually concentrated in the platform and corporate nodes, particularly Google, Meta, and ByteDance. My position, while visually central, is structurally dependent on these larger systems.

These companies function as hubs because they both develop AI systems and collect large volumes of user data. For instance, TikTok is connected not only to features like AI Effects and Symphony Creative Studio but also to data nodes such as viewing behavior and facial data. Similarly, Google connects to search history, which is further used by Gemini to generate responses. This creates a feedback loop in which user activity continuously trains and improves AI systems, reinforcing corporate control over both data and technological development.

Distinct clusters emerge within the network, including the Spotify ecosystem (AI DJ, AI Playlist, Podcast Translation), the TikTok ecosystem, and the Google/Gemini ecosystem. These clusters highlight how AI is not a single system but a set of interconnected infrastructures controlled by

different corporations. At the same time, the boundaries between these clusters are porous, as data and influence often flow across platforms.

What is most striking is what remains invisible. While data nodes are included, they are still simplified representations of much larger processes. Missing from the network are content moderators, data annotators, and communities whose data is extracted but who have little control over how it is used. This absence suggests that while the network visualizes connections, it also obscures the human labor, power imbalances, and global inequalities embedded within AI systems.

3. Artist statement:

This network visualization explores the hidden power structures within my everyday interactions with AI systems. I initially designed the network with myself at the center, assuming that I was the primary agent navigating these technologies. However, as I mapped out the relationships between platforms, features, companies, and data, a different structure emerged—one in which power is concentrated not in the user, but in the systems that collect and process data.

The visualization reveals that while users are highly connected, they are not necessarily powerful. Instead, companies like Google, Meta, and ByteDance occupy more influential positions because they control both the infrastructure and the flow of data. Data itself becomes a critical yet largely invisible node: it is constantly generated through user activity, extracted by platforms, and used to train AI features, yet it remains abstract and difficult to fully represent.

This raises questions about visibility. The network makes corporations and technologies highly visible, while the processes behind them—such as data extraction, algorithmic decision-making,

and human labor—remain obscured. By attempting to visualize these relationships, I highlight both what can be seen and what cannot.

If the network were structured differently—for example, centered on data rather than the user—it would tell a very different story: one in which individuals are not the center, but the source. This shift reframes AI not as a tool we control, but as a system that continuously learns from and reshapes us.